

Notes 6

Using Wildcards / File Globbing (quick reference)

Wildcard	Description
*	Matches zero or more characters in a filename
?	Matches any one character in a filename
[acf]	Matches one of multiple characters in a filename; in this example, a, c, or f
[a-f]	Matches one of a range of characters in a filename; in this example, any character from a through f
[!a-f]	Matches filenames that don't contain a specified range of characters; in this example, filenames that don't contain a through f

* Wildcard

- Matches 0 to any number of characters

Examples:

- list all the txt files
- `ls *.txt`

? Wildcard

- matches 1 character

Examples:

- list all hidden files
- `ls .??*`

[] Wildcard

matches 1 character from a set

Examples:

- matches 1 character from given set
- `ls f[aeiou]*`

Brace Expansion

allows to generate arbitrary strings to use with commands

Examples:

- create a whole directory structure in a single command
- `mkdir -p music/{jazz,rock}/{mp3files,videos,oggfiles}/new{1..3}`